It is noteworthy that the Indian stance of indigeneity also coincides with the global strides of anticolonial imperatives supported by the canons of subaltern inputs. In addition, the concept of indigeneity in India more or less overlaps with what can be called "tribal consciousness". Globally, the indigenous groups are subjected to a great deal of challenges. By virtue of their identity, they are often mistreated as second-class citizens by the so called "mainstream" citizens. The major challenges faced by the indigenous peoples are as follows:

Rights of the Indigenous People

The United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) was adopted on 13 September 2007 by the UN General Assembly. As the most comprehensive international instrument on the indigenous peoples' rights, it seeks to ensure a "universal framework of minimum standards for the survival, dignity and well-being of the indigenous peoples of the worlds". The Declaration contains 46 Articles which is the outcome of a drafting process which began in 1985 by the Working Group on Indigenous Populations. In its essence, the UNDRIP is a manual for the governments of the world on how to revere the human rights of the indigenous communities. It also serves in helping the enforcement of other mechanisms, affecting indigenous groups, like the Convention on the Rights of the Child, ILO Convention 169, and the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women.

Human Rights, Self-Determination and Nationality	
Articles 1 – 6	❖ Right to all human rights ❖ Right to freedom and equality and right against exploitation ❖ Right to self-determination ❖ Right to autonomy or self-government ❖ Right to maintain their distinct political, legal, economic, social and cultural identity ❖ Right to nationality
Life, Liberty, Culture and Security	
Articles 7 – 10	❖ Right to life, liberty and security ❖ Right against forced assimilation or destruction of culture ❖ Right to belong to an indigenous community or a nation ❖ Right against forced removal or relocation
Culture, Religion and Language	
Articles 11-13	❖ Right to culture ❖ Right to spiritual and religious traditions and customs ❖ Right to know and use language, histories and oral traditions

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